RESIST! (clockwise from left) Ritu Sarin and Tenzing Sonam; Lhamo Tsering and others; Classroom at Camp Hale; members of the Mustang Resistance Force; and Lhamo Tsering's CIA-issued camera, compass and a map of Tibet



Courtesy: BRUCE WALKER, HOOVER INSTITUTION

We spent a summer in Washington, DC, researching these elusive figures."

In 1957, the CIA started work in Saipan by training a pilot group of six Tibetans in guerrilla warfare and radio communications and they were parachuted back into Tibet. Then, in 1958, they twice airdropped weapons to fighters in Tibet. Encouraged by the operation's success, the CIA also set up Camp Hale in the Colorado Rocky Mountains, where nearly 259 Tibetans were trained between 1959 and 1964. Amongst the exhibits at *Shadow Circus* are CIA-issued maps, drawings from the Guerrilla Handbook made by Tibetan trainees at Camp Hale, Tsering's camera, binoculars and a compass given to him by the CIA. "A lot of the documents that we collected are from the CIA's archives and Eisenhower Presidential Library archives. Some of those will be on display as well," says Sonam. He also adds that IIC visitors will be able to hear an audio clip in which the Dalai Lama implores the Mustang guerrillas to surrender.

When the CIA pulled out abruptly in 1970, Tibetans did feel betrayed, but "accepted that they were the only people who came to their aid in any meaningful way," says Sarin. Over the years, the Tibetan freedom struggle turned non-violent, and this clandestine operation has almost been forgotten. "We thought it was important to tell this story and remind the world of the sacrifices made by so many Tibetans who took up arms to defend their country," says Sonam. ■

– Anu Prabhakar

ART/ PHOTOGRAPHY

An Open Mind

An online exhibition is laying bare the human mind by exploring its myriad complexities

Though excellently curated by the Science Gallery, Bengaluru, *PSYCHE* can feel a little overwhelming. Besides the 10 exhibits that all delve into the complexities of the human mind, this online exhibition also features six films and over 40 live programmes that include virtual masterclasses, workshops and public lectures. It also gives access to books, podcasts, games and graphic novels. *PSYCHE* isn't just about mental health. It also focuses on forensic psychology, hypnosis, AI and psychedelics.

Speaking of the collaboration with the National Institute of Mental Health and Neurosciences (NIMHANS), The Wellbeing Project and Museum Dr. Guislain, Dr Jahnavi Phalke, founding director of the Science Gallery, says, "This has been an exciting opportunity to bring together academics, curators and artists to debate questions concerning the social and sometimes not-so-social lives of our mind. It is inspiring to learn of the still unanswered and unexplored big questions in a cluster of related yet specific fields– psychology, psychoanalysis, psychiatry, neurosciences, philosophy among others."

Put together by psychiatrists Alok Sarin, Sanjeev Jain, and Pratima Murthy, 'The Asylum' is perhaps the best exhibit to start with. By helping us trace the fascinating histories of asylums in Delhi, Ranchi, Kolkata, Chennai and Bengaluru, the exhibit helps us map the trajectory of mental health treatment in India. Earlier known as 'The Lunatic Asylum', NIMHANS, we learn, was the first facility to be built for mental health treatment and this is where India's first lobotomy was performed.

PSYCHE explores the history of mental health treatment in India while also debating questions concerning the mind

Other notable exhibits include the audio-visual 'Black Men's Reality' (about Black men's mental health), 'Change My Mind' (implications of brain implants on minds), 'Playing with Reality' (an award-winning interactive work on psychosis) and 'Hamlet's Live' (six monologues about social media).

An interactive game, 'The Serpent of a Thousand Coils', can seem a touch unnerving in the way it leads viewers through a tricky maze, towards their individual fears. Artist Anuj Malhotra, who battles OCD, says the game is a manifestation of his reality. A player is given the choice to inhabit one of two narrative circumstances that have transpired within a fictional small town. As they navigate the story, the game poses a series of questions, each of which has two possible answers. Malhotra says, "The layout of this inquisition is based on the discoveries made by Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky in the field of decision research, which was presented in the book, *Thinking, Fast and Slow*." ■

–Jayanthi Madhukar





MIND GAMES Stills from 'Black Men's Minds'; and 'The Asylum' (right)